



# Air Quality Situation Report

Edmonton Folk Music Festival ·  
Gallagher Park

Wed, Aug 5, 2026 · 10:42 PM MDT  
For more information, contact Gary Redmond, ACA Executive Director at 780.935.4279

## Air Quality Health Index (AQHI) — Edmonton

# 2.0

Current AQHI at Edmonton McCauley (1.66 km from venue)  
Forecast Thu 12:00 AM: 1.9

| Health Risk | AQHI | At-Risk Population                   | General Population                        |
|-------------|------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Low Risk    | 2.0  | Enjoy your usual outdoor activities. | Ideal air quality for outdoor activities. |

No active Environment Canada weather alerts for the venue.

## Environmental Intelligence Summary

- At Edmonton Folk Music Festival, temperature is 17.9°C and feels near 17.1°C. Winds are 13 km/h from SW, gusting near 26 km/h.
- The nearest current AQHI is 2 at Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km from the venue.
- The official Government of Alberta AQHI for Edmonton is 2 (forecast tonight: 3, tomorrow: 3).
- A gridded AQHI estimate blending official and community sensors (confidence: High) puts the area near 1.
- The nearest air monitoring station (Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km) reports fine particulate matter (PM2.5) at 12.3 µg/m³.
- An on-site community sensor ('ACA\_EFMF-Office', 0.3 km) reads 11.2 µg/m³ PM2.5.
- Back-trajectory modeling (HRDPS wind fields, 6 h lookback) indicates the air currently at the venue traveled from the vicinity of a point 113.1 km to the N, i.e. arriving from the N.
- The nearest active fire detection (NASA FIRMS – VIIRS, last 2026-08-05) is 5.6 km E of the venue. The modeled back-trajectory passes within 5.6 km of this fire, making smoke transport to the venue plausible based on wind-field modeling.
- The AQHI forecast for Thu 12:00 AM is 2.
- Precipitation probability reaches approximately 100%.
- Overall operational environmental risk is HIGH. Primary concerns are precipitation.

## Recommendations

- Prepare drainage, electrical protection and wet-weather controls.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — general population: Ideal air quality for outdoor activities.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — at-risk populations: Enjoy your usual outdoor activities.

## Hazard Snapshot — Overall Risk: High Risk

|                                                                 |                                                     |                                                                     |                                                       |                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| AIR QUALITY<br><b>Low Risk</b><br>2.0 AQHI                      | HEAT<br><b>Low Risk</b><br>20.9 °C apparent/humidex | WIND<br><b>Moderate Risk</b><br>47.9 km/h peak gust                 | PRECIPITATION<br><b>High Risk</b><br>1.6 mm/h maximum | THUNDERSTORM<br><b>Moderate Risk</b><br>— first forecast signal |
| AQHI RATE OF CHANGE<br><b>Low Risk</b><br>-1.0 AQHI change/hour |                                                     | WIND SHEAR<br><b>Low Risk</b><br>5.9 ° direction diff (10m vs 120m) |                                                       |                                                                 |

## Local Monitoring

|                                                              |                                                   |                                                                     |                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nearest station<br><b>2.0</b><br>Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km | Blended estimate<br><b>1.0</b><br>confidence High | PM2.5 (station)<br><b>12.3 µg/m³</b><br>Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km | PM2.5 (community)<br><b>11.2 µg/m³</b><br>ACA_EFMF-Office · 0.31 km |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|

